Other companies have faced similar intimidation. In January 2018, in the face of Beijing's pressure, hotel giant Marriott shut down its websites in China for a week, after one of its online questionnaires listed Tibet, Taiwan, Macao, and Hong Kong as independent countries. Once again, the company made public penance, and its CEO sounded more like a foreign minister than a corporate executive, publicly announcing that Marriott "respects and supports Chinese sovereignty and its territorial integrity." Even more Orwellian, in a separate incident Marriott fired an employee who "liked" a post by a Tibetan independence group on one of the company's social media sites.[54] It appears that international corporations are willing to let Beijing determine how they manage internal employment issues when their trade in China appears at risk. In addition to Marriott and the forty global airlines who caved to China's demand to flush Taiwan down the memory hole, car maker Audi, clothes chain Zara, medical instrument maker Medtronic, and others have fallen afoul of Beijing's outrage machine. Each has apologized for some perceived infraction or has altered company practices to suit Beijing's demands, in essence supporting Beijing's foreign policy goals.

How long such pressure tactics will continue to be successful, however, is being tested the more brazen that China gets. After the general manager of the National Basketball Association's Houston Rockets tweeted in support of Hong Kong's prodemocracy demonstrations in October 2019, the Chinese government and business punished the NBA, threatening its multibillion-dollar business in China. Chinese stores pulled the team's merchandise from stores, and broadcasters stopped showing Rockets games and threatened to cancel the league's China appearances. Following the usual script, the NBA and some of its biggest stars responded by publicly apologizing, yet this time their cravenness sparked an enormous political backlash in the United States over free-speech rights.[55]

It is not merely international business that finds itself kowtowing to Beijing. Moving from intimidation to seduction, China's global